Your guide to the clue workshop

ADULT ONLY - contains answers. Keep this guide separate from the seven player sheets.

What this pack includes

Six independent puzzles: two codes, two logic tasks and two routes. They can be used separately or in any order. This is not a complete story-based escape room; there are no physical locks, timer or required room search.

Print and prepare

Print the seven player pages single-sided at 100% on matching US Letter paper. One complete player set per team is a starting point. Read this five-page guide on screen, or print it once. Prepare pencils. No colour-dependent clue is used.

Choose a starting point

The puzzles are designed for children aged 6-12 with adult help as needed. Reading and experience vary. Inspect the sheets first. Try the delivery queue or forest trail first. Puzzle 1 now involves inferring a code from four old records before combining five records to reconstruct a five-stop delivery route. It uses two player pages.

Share the information

For puzzle 4, an adult can cut the three helper clues from beneath the diagram and give one to each player. Leave the parcel picture and question intact. Players tell one another their clues and agree on the parcel. With fewer players, take turns or let the adult read a clue.

Help without giving everything away

Ask players to explain their thinking before checking the answer. Give one hint at a time; allow another attempt before the next hint. The last hint can be very direct. If the group wants to stop, read the explained solution together.

How you may use these files

Print for your own household or the classes you teach. Retain the Paper Adventure credit. Do not resell or republish these PDF files; share the public page link instead. These are original Paper Adventure puzzle materials.

The post office: two-stage solution

01 - The rain-soaked post office

Stage 1 - restore the key

Hint 1: Compare lengths first: a three-shape record needs a three-letter label; a four-shape record needs four letters.

Hint 2: Try a label on A, then use the same shape-letter matches to read B. Does B become one of the other labels?

Hint 3: If A were PALM, B would read MAPL, which is not a label. Try the other four-letter label, then restore the key.

Stage 2 - reconstruct the route

Route hint 1: Find the two stops that must be consecutive. Keep them together when trying different orders; then test PALM two positions before or after POOL.

Route hint 2: PALM cannot be two positions before POOL while satisfying records 1 and 4. The continuous group is POOL, LOOM, PALM.

Route hint 3: The three-stop group must occupy positions 3-5. Compare OAK and MALL in positions 1-2 with record 5 to choose their direction.

Answer: OAK MALL POOL LOOM PALM

Stage 1: A=LAMP, B=PALM, C=MAP, D=OAK. If A were PALM, B would read MAPL, which is not a label. The restored key is diamond=L, triangle=A, star=M, cross=P, circle=O, square=K. Stage 2: record 1 decodes to MALL before PALM; record 3 says POOL immediately before LOOM. Combine POOL-LOOM with record 2. If PALM is two positions before POOL, records 1 and 4 cannot both hold. Therefore the group is POOL-LOOM-PALM. It cannot occupy positions 1-3 because MALL must precede PALM, nor positions 2-4 because OAK and MALL could not be neighbours. It occupies positions 3-5. Record 5 excludes MALL-OAK-POOL-LOOM-PALM. The only route is OAK MALL POOL LOOM PALM. Deliver the final letter to PALM.

Messages and parcels

02 - The moon-station message

Hint 1: Find a sent letter in the lower row. Read the original letter directly above it.

Hint 2: F becomes C, K becomes H and H becomes E. The first word begins CHE.

Hint 3: Decode the whole message, then answer with only the colour it names.

Answer: RED

Moving each sent letter back three places gives CHECK THE RED STAR. The requested colour is RED.

03 - The delivery queue

Hint 1: Put SUN in the first position before trying the other parcels.

Hint 2: Keep STAR and MOON together, in that order. Try the two places where that pair could fit.

Hint 3: If STAR and MOON were second and third, LEAF would be last. That breaks a clue.

Answer: MOON

SUN must be first. STAR-MOON cannot occupy positions two and three, because that leaves LEAF last. The only order is SUN, LEAF, STAR, MOON. MOON goes last.

Evidence and trails

04 - The right parcel

Hint 1: A parcel must satisfy all three helpers, not just one of them.

Hint 2: Cross out B because its wrapping has dots. Compare the seals and stamp counts on the others.

Hint 3: A has too few stamps and D has the wrong seal. Which parcel is left?

Answer: C

C has stripes, a triangle seal and two stamps. A fails the stamp clue, B fails the wrapping clue and D fails the seal clue. Only C matches all three.

05 - The forest trail

Hint 1: East is right, south is down and west is left. Each move travels exactly one square.

Hint 2: Your first two moves land on B and R. Write those down in that order.

Hint 3: After B and R, move down, left, down and right. Keep one letter from every landing square.

Answer: BRIDGE

The six landing squares give B, R, I, D, G and E. They spell BRIDGE. The starting S is not part of the message.

The harbour crossing

06 - The harbour crossing

Hint 1: Because MILL is forbidden, the first bridge must go from DOCK to OAK.

Hint 2: You must visit BELL and use only three bridges in total. Compare OAK's two onward choices.

Hint 3: The route is DOCK > OAK > BELL > BEACON. Read the numbers on those three bridges in order.

Answer: 258

Avoiding MILL forces DOCK-OAK. To visit BELL within three bridges, continue OAK-BELL-BEACON. The bridge numbers are 2, 5 and 8, giving 258.